

Another way to have someone else pay for your schooling is by performing military service. Gwen, of the blog *Fiery Millennials*, enrolled in an Air National Guard program that provided a full scholarship. She then obtained an academic scholarship that paid her entire college tuition. While many on the standard path believe it's impossible to go to college without rich parents or loans, Gwen was able to get two full rides to college. She wasn't able to "double dip," so she utilized the academic scholarship and graduated with no student debt plus credit for an additional eight semesters of college from the Air National Guard program if she chooses to go back to school in the future. Her work with the Guard contributed to her ability to save \$10,000 by the time she graduated. This provided a solid financial foundation for her after college.

If you can't get some or all your college paid for, you can still lower the cost of a degree through intelligent planning and hard work. Both Cody Berman and Gwen each put tremendous thought and effort into strategically obtaining a college degree for minimal cost.

Each discussed slightly different strategies to earn college credits while in high school, including AP courses, CLEP exams, and dual enrollment with community colleges. These strategies have a double benefit. They enable you to obtain college credits at a far lower cost